



MIT SLOAN SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT
MIT SCHWARZMAN COLLEGE OF COMPUTING



MODULE 2 UNIT 2
Media Set Video 1 Transcript

Module 2 Unit 2 Media Set Video 1 Transcript

Build, buy, or stack

PAUL MCDONAGH-SMITH: When you're working with agent frameworks, the platforms, the models, how do you go about explaining the difference to business leaders? So business leaders will kind of come to your office or, you know, you have these kind of meetings, you've created your pitch deck kind of using Gemini and other tools and everything else. How do you go about explaining the difference of these new potentialities to business leaders and how do you think they should, from the other side, be deciding which approaches to pursue with agentic AI?

KANCHANA PATLOLLA: So, most times, like when you're talking, people are familiar with the approach, particularly because they're all used to this build versus buy versus stack. They are all aware of, you know, kind of things. But the pros and cons of the frameworks, models, platforms, all of this comes with the level of autonomy the customer wants or needs to have. Like, say, if you consider, in each of these stack, right, if you think about models, most folks I have seen, or most enterprises, I should say, I have seen are formalized in the, finalized in the closed models locale. But they would want to pick a vendor because they want to be, you know, each of them does have a kind of a vendor lock-in, I would say, and they would want to be in that space. And there are very few who experiment with the public LLMs. You know, they want to be able to have their own, you know, ability to create their own, all of that, which there is certain businesses which needs it. So I agree with it.

So even the framework stack or the platform stack, which is, you know, build everything by yourself with a layer or a platform, which is you know just buy everything. All of this comes to autonomy. At the end of the day, do you have the skill set for your people to be able to support it? Do you want that part of your core business even? Because you might not want to have a full agentic ecosystem with everything in there, because you are considering, like, building for this specific problem versus you have, say, ten customers, enterprise customers, you're supporting, maybe you should be having your own agentic ecosystem, because you don't want to be dependent on a platform.

So it depends on of course the use case of who you're building for and also that level of autonomy and skill set you have. The last thing I would say though, it doesn't have to be one or the other or the other.

MCDONAGH-SMITH: Good point.

PATLOLLA: Like, it could be a combination of all three in your enterprise. I have several enterprises who end up doing all three.

SPEAKER: Did you understand all the concepts covered in this video? If you'd like to review any of the content, please click on the chapter menu.